
Operational Policy

Policy title: Administrative, Technical and Physical Safeguards of Information Policy

Policy number: ODHSOHA 090-009

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Approved by: Kris Kautz, OHA and Seth Lyon, ODHS

Purpose

The Oregon Department of Human Services (ODHS) and Oregon Health Authority (OHA) are committed to protecting the information assets and systems of the agencies. This policy establishes criteria to safeguard protected information and minimize the risk of unauthorized access, use, or disclosure

Description

This policy describes the responsibilities of ODHS and OHA staff to safeguard information assets and systems and to manage associated risks during daily work, whether in the office or remotely. Staff are expected to exercise discretion regarding information shared in documents or conversations, maintain the security of workplace surroundings, and ensure the protection of information transported outside of the worksite.

Applicability

This policy applies to all ODHS and OHA staff, including full-time, part-time, contingent, temporary, and limited duration employees, volunteers, trainees, and interns. The requirements of this policy also apply to contractors, grantees, and partners in their delivery of goods or services to or on behalf of either agency, as required under the applicable contract, grant, or other form of agreement.

As keepers of the public trust, all ODHS and OHA staff play a vital role in upholding state and agency policies, administrative rules, and state and federal laws. ODHS and OHA are committed to exceptional public and customer service. The agencies are dedicated to maintaining standards of exceptional service and trust staff to do the same. Failure to follow policies, rules and laws may result in beginning a personnel process to consider formal action as appropriate, including progressive discipline up to and including dismissal from state service.

Policy

1. ODHS and OHA shall implement administrative, technical, and physical safeguards to protect information assets from unauthorized access, use or disclosure. Examples of information assets include:
 - a. Data and information.
 - b. Information technology (IT) systems.
 - c. IT networks.
 - d. Software.
 - e. Hardware.
 - f. Network devices.
 - g. Digital and physical media.
2. ODHS and OHA staff shall protect information assets, including but not limited to, personally identifiable information (PII), protected health information (PHI), federal tax information (FTI), criminal justice Information (CJI), and Social Security Administration (SSA) information.
3. Geofencing controls shall be implemented to restrict access to sensitive systems and data from unauthorized or high-risk geographic locations according to the Statewide Information Technology (IT) Control Standards.¹
4. ODHS and OHA shall monitor agencies' information asset use in accordance with agency policies and procedures including but not limited to Department of Administrative Services (DAS), federal and state requirements.

¹ Statewide Information Technology (IT) Control Standards CM-2(7)

5. Information system owners shall ensure systems managed by ODHS and OHA, Department of Administrative Services (DAS) Enterprise Information Services (EIS), DAS EIS Data Center Services (DCS), and hosted service providers, have secure installations, secure configurations, and management for all information assets.
6. Information systems owners are ODHS and OHA staff who are responsible for the overall procurement, development, integration, modification, or operation and maintenance of an information system.²
7. The agency is responsible for maintaining current inventory of information assets and the accuracy of its environment in collaboration with the Office of Information Services (OIS) teams and leadership oversight.
8. All ODHS and OHA staff are responsible for safeguarding information assets and systems to prevent unauthorized access and disclosure. To fulfill this responsibility, staff shall:
 - a. Use only agency-approved software and systems for handling agency data. (Refer to *IT Standards and Approved Products List* available in the Reference section of this policy).
 - b. Use only agency-approved portable devices or other storage media that are encrypted with agency-approved encryption technologies with the following minimum standards:
 - A. A. For data at rest at a minimum shall be Advanced Encryption Standard (AES-XTS)-XTS-256.
 - B. B. For data in transit at a minimum shall be Transport Layer Security (TLS) 1.2.
 - c. Secure their agency-issued devices at all times and report any loss or theft immediately to their supervisor, the OIS Service Desk, Information Security and Privacy Office (ISPO), and their local police department. (Refer to ODHSOHA 090-009-03 Lost or Stolen Computer Process and ODHSOHA 070-001-02 Lost or Stolen Mobile Communication Device).

² National Institutes of Standards and Technology (NIST) Special Publication (SP) 800-53 Rev. 5

- d. Comply with all agency remote work policies and procedures, and shall use only agency-approved equipment and remote access systems.³
- e. Safeguard approved peripheral equipment such as printers, copiers, fax machines, smart boards, cameras, and other devices, from inadvertent or unauthorized access, and comply with DAS 107-004-110 Acceptable Use of State Information Assets Policy.
- f. Accurately prepare and protect information sent via fax and send securely to authorized recipients only, except FTI which shall not be transmitted via fax. [Refer to Oregon Administrative Rules (OAR) 943-014-0000(33)]
- g. Ensure that any transmission of agency information is sent to an authorized recipient.
- h. Securely store and transport documents.
 - A. Hard copies of protected documents shall be securely stored in locked rooms or containers.
 - B. Centralized storage areas for protected materials shall be appropriately labeled and locked.
 - C. ODHS and OHA staff authorized to remove documents from the worksite shall maintain physical custody and control, and secure the documents.
- i. Take reasonable steps to protect the confidentiality of verbal exchanges of protected information regardless of where the discussion occurs.
 - A. Verbal exchanges of protected information shall occur only when members of the workforce have taken appropriate steps to secure the privacy of the exchange, and with authorized recipients only.
 - B. Each ODHS and OHA worksite shall ensure staff are aware that protected information can be unintentionally disclosed during conversations.

³ DAS 50-050-01 Working Remotely

- j. Not use publicly accessible electronic devices to access, process, store, or transmit agency information assets, such as a library or hotel computer.
- k. Not share information assets through publicly available cloud storage solutions or applications (anything not approved and purchased through agency processes).
- l. Not intentionally introduce any computer code designed to self-replicate, damage or otherwise hinder the performance of information assets or systems.
- m. Not connect any devices unless they are owned or approved by a state agency.

References

[Center for Internet Security Controls](#)

[Criminal Justice Information Services \(CJIS\) Security Policy](#)

[Federal Information Processing Standards \(FIPS\) Publication \(Pub\) 199](#)

[Standards for Security Categorization of Federal Information and Information Systems](#)

[Federal Information Processing Standards \(FIPS\) Publication \(Pub\) 200 Minimum Security Requirements for Federal Information and Information Systems](#)

[IRS Publication 1075, Tax Information Security Guidelines for Federal, State and Local Agencies](#)

[Acceptable Risk Controls for Affordable Care Act \(ACA\), Medicaid, and Partner Entities \(ARC-AMPE\)](#)

[National Institute of Standards and Technology \(NIST\) 800-53 Rev. 5 Security and Privacy Controls for Information Systems and Organizations](#)

[Social Security Administration Information Exchange Security Requirements and Procedures](#)

[Statewide Information Technology \(IT\) Control Standards](#)

[45 CFR 160 General Administrative Requirements](#)

[45 CFR 164 Security and Privacy](#)

[OAR 125-055-0100 to 125-055-0130 HIPAA Privacy and Security Rule](#)

[Implementations; HITECH Act Implementation](#)

[OAD 166-017-0090 Records Destruction Requirements for Electronic Records](#)
[OAD 943-014-0400 to 943-014-0465 Privacy and Confidentiality](#)
[ODHSOHA 010-018 Record Retention and Management Policy](#)
[ODHSOHA 090-009-03 Lost or Stolen Computer Process](#)
[ODHSOHA 070-001-02 Lost or Stolen Mobile Communication Device](#)
[ODHSOHA 090-015 Email Security Policy](#)
[Email Encryption for ODHSOHA Employees](#)
[Information Technology and Approved Products List](#)
[ODHSOHA 090-007-01 Continuous Vulnerability Assessment Process](#)

Related policies

[DAS 107-004-051 Controlling Portable and Removable Storage Devices](#)
[DAS 107-004-052 Cyber and Information Security](#)
[DAS 107-004-100 Transporting Information Assets](#)
[DAS 107-004-110 Acceptable Use of State Information Assets](#)
[DAS 107-004-120 Cyber and Information Security Incident Response](#)
[DAS 107-004-120 Cyber and Information Security Incident Response](#)
[DAS 50-050.01 Working Remotely](#)
[ODHSOHA 070-014 Information Technology Asset Management Policy](#)
[OHA-010-023 Flexible Work Solutions](#)

This policy shall be reviewed at least once every year to ensure relevance.

Contact

Information Security and Privacy Office (ISPO)

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Policy history

Version 1 DHS 090-009 established 11/08/2004

Replaced by joint policy and renamed

Version 1 DHSOHA-090-009 established 03/11/2015

Version 2 DHSOHA-090-009 revised 03/04/2016

Version 3 DHSOHA-090-009 revised 02/05/2018

Version 4 ODHSOHA revised 08/02/2021

Version 5 ODHSOHA revised 07/11/2022

Version 6 ODHSOHA revised 12/04/2023

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